

Prerequisites

- I must have an officially approved plan of study on file.
- I will complete my foundational coursework, encompassing my 21 transfer credits and my targeted Purdue coursework up through the Fall 2027 semester.
- I must maintain good academic standing with a minimum 3.0 GPA and ensure I have no unresolved grades below a B- in my core courses.
- I will satisfy any world language requirements dictated by the department.
- I need to finalize my preliminary examining committee with my advisor, Dr. Heung Jin Oh, ensuring it consists of at least three graduate faculty members and that a majority hold regular graduate faculty certification.

Preparation Tasks

- I will meet with my advisor to refine my research problem identification and establish my Fall 2027 preliminary exam timeline.
- At least 10 weeks before the exam date, I must develop a comprehensive reading list drawing from my literature review of 200+ papers.
- I will commit 20+ hours per week to focused exam preparation and research design.
- I will create a study plan focused on synthesizing theories, critiquing research designs, and integrating literature, rather than relying on rote memorization.
- I will familiarize myself with the written exam's formatting requirements, ensuring I use APA style, double spacing, 1-inch margins, and include separate reference lists for each question response.
- I need to prepare for my oral exam by reviewing my written answers and anticipating follow-up questions from my committee that draw from my approved reading list.

Administrative Tasks

- Exactly 9 weeks before the exam date, I must submit my reading list to the preliminary exam committee for approval.
- I need to confirm the scheduled dates for both the written and oral components with my committee at least 4 weeks before the exam.
- After receiving reading list approval from the committee (which takes up to 2 weeks), I will have 6 weeks to complete the written component.
- I must submit my written exam responses immediately upon completion so the committee can evaluate them within 2 weeks.
- If my written exam is approved, I will attend the oral component, which must be scheduled within 2 weeks of the written approval.
- Once I successfully pass both the written and oral components in a single administration, I will ensure the Chair of my committee submits the electronic Form 10 to the Graduate School within 1 week.

Transition Tasks

- Following the prelim, I will spend 18-20+ hours per week writing my 30-50 page dissertation proposal to finalize my research design and methods.
- I will schedule and defend my proposal 12 months after my prelim, in Fall 2028.
- I will transition into Semesters 9 and 10 (Spring and Summer 2029) to dedicate 25+ hours per week to intensive data collection and analysis.
- I will prepare for my final dissertation defense and graduation in Fall 2029.